

Covenant (restrictive) – An enforceable restriction on how a property can be altered. It can relate to something as simple as what sort of letterbox can be installed, or the colour the new owner can paint the exterior of the property.

Crown land – Land owned by state or federal governments.

Deed – A signed document that passes ownership of property between parties.

Deposit – Percentage of the cost of the property, or an agreed amount, paid when the sale contract is signed.

Easement – A right to use land belonging to someone else, or to prevent the owner of that land from using it in a particular way. This is most often used where government authorities have the right to run, for example, electrical mains or drainage through a person's private property.

Encumbrance – A registered interest, found on a property's title, by a party who is not the property's owner. An easement is an example of an encumbrance.

Exchange of contracts – A legal process whereby the deposit is paid, and the vendor and buyer sign a copy of the sale contract and exchange these documents – it is now legally binding. The next stage is settlement.

First refusal (right of) – The privilege to have first right to buy real estate.

Fittings – Items in the property that can be removed without causing damage.

Fixtures – Commonly refer to irremovable features such as carpets and awnings, which come with the property.

Holding deposit – An amount given by a buyer to the vendor's agent, demonstrating a serious commitment to the property.

Interest – The payment made by a borrower to a lender in return for the loan of money, in addition to the principal repayments.